

Cover your tracks

Google now monitors your web behavior before targeting ads

14

The best use Linux

CERN uses a variant of Scientific Linux to run the LHC, version 5.2 is on the DVD

XP Piracy

Windows XP is the most used operating system in the world, at 64%. However, upto 35% of all machines that run XP are believed to be using a pirated version

Tech Expert

I am from Darbhanga, Bihar. I live in a small village named Sara Mohan Pur, and I am a student of GNIIT. Can you believe, that at NIIT and in my village, my friends call me "the Tech Expert", and it's all because I've been reading *Digit* for over a year now. I am a really big fan of your magazine, and the software you provide in your DVDs. I really like Agent 001, Buzzword, Editorial, and Crossword, so please bring the crossword back. Instead of trailers and videos, you should provide more software for desktop enhancement, security, programming and operating systems such as Windows 7 (beta). Also, keep up the good work.

Imbeshat Ahmad Khan
Darbhanga, Bihar.

The crossword is back. About the Trailers and videos, sorry, but we get so many requests for those that it would be an injustice to others to not put them in. (See the next letter)

Editor

Best issue ever

This is the edition that I was eagerly awaiting! The *Digit* videos were good. I've looked forward to these for ages now. This issue was full of knowledge, entertainment and fun, and was very enjoyable. The new look of *Digit* is sexy.

I loved the HDTV, Desktop PC and MP3 player tests, as well as the Tips & Tricks to Windows 7. The new Consumer Protection section is great, and I'm glad you're informing us of our rights.

The Price Watch section was truly amazing, so please make sure it stays in *Digit 3.0* as well. Please provide minimum system requirements for all your game reviews. If you can, I'd also like some Windows 7 themes. Also, more *Digit* Videos please.

Absolutely the best issue of *Digit* ever. I can't wait for the next issue, and am eager to get my hands on it.

Mayur Gaikwad
Satara, Maharashtra

Price Watch is a regular section, don't worry.

Editor

Simple and superb

I bought *Digit* for the first time and I must say it was just superb. Everything was up to the mark. *Digit* introduced me to tech news. I loved the articles especially the mobile phone wish list, the review of IE8, search engines, home cinema and "When size matters" by Agent 001. I also liked the Tips & Tricks, and your Fast Track *ne*

hila ke rakh diya! The Drool maal was also amazing. This was the first time I have read any tech mag, and I am thankful that I bought it. To be honest, it was the attractive cover that made me buy it. But now I think that it was perhaps the best thing in that entire book store. The DVDs were also amazing.

I wanted to ask you about piracy. My PC has Windows XP installed, but I'm sure it's not original. In fact, I don't think I have any original software. What do I do? Open source is an option, but what about the OS. Please give us some tips on how we can avoid piracy.

Regarding HD trailers, I can't watch them because my PC is eight years old. I am planning to buy a new PC soon. You guys are marvelous to the power of infinity.

Devashish Dixit
Jabalpur

I bought *Digit* magazine for the first time in February 2009, only for the DVDs. I didn't think there would be anything great in the magazine. After I was done with all the software, I would look at the cover, because it looked good, but didn't really read any articles. However, when I tried to get my hands on the March issue, and found that it was sold out, I sat down to read the February magazine. After I saw the contents inside it, I realised what I was missing. It's not you or me that's to blame for this misconception, but the other magazines in the market! I really salute you guys for giving us such a wonderful magazine... all in simple language! My God, I found that I was able to understand everything easily, because you write in a manner that anyone who can read English can understand. The Fast Track is even better in this respect. Although I don't know too much about computers, I feel that I have learnt a great deal after reading just a single issue. I've even successfully installed and tried my hands on Linux thanks to you. All thanks to you guys; keep up the good work.

R.B.Vigneshwar
Sivagangai, Tamil Nadu

Devashish, you can stop using pirated software, and yes you don't even need to pirate the OS. You can just use Linux for free instead. Get your hands on our Fast Track to Linux, and you'll see how easy it is to install and use Linux – even on your old PC!

The cover designer thanks both of you for proving that he did an excellent job.

Editor

Letter of the month

I've been reading *Digit* regularly for over two years. Over the past few months, I've noticed *Digit* undergoing some major changes. I thought you guys were already the No. 1 tech magazine in India. Why make so many changes? Aren't you trying a little too hard to beat the competition?

As a reader of *Digit* and the "tech-guru" amongst my family and friends, let me congratulate you on this month's magazine. In my humble opinion, you've achieved the goal of transforming the best magazine into the Ultra-Best. Everything from Buzz to the game reviews was awesome this month.

Price watch, Developers' Corner and DIY are some of the best additions to the magazine. Also, please do give the latest software on your DVD. The contents are good, but I was a bit disappointed not to get Vista-SP2 and Windows 7 beta this month.

Choosing a tech-product today is not very easy (thanks to you, it isn't that difficult either). But choosing a tech service such as an ISP, mobile service or Digital TV can be a nightmare. The companies fail to mention hidden costs. I got a postpaid wireless internet connection - Rs. 400 per month. Anyone would think that this was all they would have to pay, but when you get your bill you see a whole list of extra taxes. I'm not against taxes, but I think not mentioning them in a brochure is just not fair. I've even seen an ISP claim that for Rs. 499 they offer a 3.1 Mbps connection with unlimited downloads. Of course, you have to read the fine print which states that the term "unlimited," according to their "fair use policy" is equal to 10 GB data transfer, after which you have to pay Rs. 2 per extra MB!

In your Q&A section, Rajesh Das had asked about a problem regarding blurred images while using the internet. One possible reason for this is that he might have a software called Reliance Netbooster installed. This comes in the USB modem driver's disc that's given to Reliance NetConnect users. He should uninstall this software, because it tries to "Optimize" your speed by reducing the image quality in your browser.

Keep up the good work.

Rajan Kinkhede
Nagpur